

Site Deployment Checklist

Reusing the AI Website Editor for a new business on Hostinger

Part 1 — Get all accounts and API keys first

Do these before touching anything else. You'll paste these values into the server later.

1.1 — OpenAI API Key (REQUIRED)

Powers the entire AI chat editor. Site is broken without it.

- Go to **platform.openai.com/api-keys**
- Click **Create new secret key**
- Copy it (only shown once)
- Add billing at **platform.openai.com/settings/organization/billing**

Cost: roughly \$0.005–\$0.015 per AI chat turn (GPT-4o pricing).

1.2 — GitHub Personal Access Token (REQUIRED)

Lets the admin panel save content changes back to GitHub so they persist.

- Go to **github.com/settings/tokens/new**
- Name: *client-name-content*
- Expiration: **No expiration** (or 1 year)
- Scopes: tick **repo** (the entire top-level box)
- Click **Generate token** and copy immediately

1.3 — Unsplash Access Key (OPTIONAL but recommended)

Lets the AI search real photos. Without it, placeholder images are used.

- Go to **unsplash.com/developers**
- Click **Your apps** → **New Application**
- Copy the **Access Key** (NOT the Secret Key)

1.4 — Hostinger Hosting Plan + Domain (REQUIRED)

Buy a shared hosting plan and add a domain to it.

From Hostinger's **SSH Access** panel, copy:

- Host IP address
- SSH Port (usually **65002** on shared)
- SSH Username
- SSH Password

Part 2 — Duplicate the GitHub repository

2.1 — Import the repo

- Go to github.com/new/import
- Source URL: <https://github.com/nikolassigmadev/builder>
- New name: *client-businessname*
- Privacy: **Private**
- Click **Begin import**

2.2 — Update the deploy workflow

In your new repo, edit `.github/workflows/deploy.yml` and change these lines to match the new server:

```
host: YOUR_NEW_SERVER_IP
port: 65002
username: YOUR_NEW_USERNAME
cd ~/domains/your-new-domain.com/public_html
```

2.3 — Add the SSH password as a GitHub Secret

- Go to [github.com/\[your-username\]/\[new-repo\]/settings/secrets/actions](https://github.com/[your-username]/[new-repo]/settings/secrets/actions)
- Click **New repository secret**
- Name: **SSH_PASSWORD**
- Value: your Hostinger SSH password
- Click **Add secret**

Part 3 — Generate password hash and session secret

Run these commands on your Mac, inside the project folder, BEFORE you set up the server.

3.1 — Bcrypt password hash

Decide what admin password the client will use, then run:

```
cd "/Users/nikolasdzhovanis/gym-website 2"
node -e "require('bcryptjs').hash('YOUR_PASSWORD_HERE', 12).then(h => console.log(h))"
```

Copy the output (starts with `$2b$12$...`). This becomes **ADMIN_PASSWORD_HASH**.

3.2 — Session secret (64-char random string)

```
node -e "console.log(require('crypto').randomBytes(32).toString('hex'))"
```

Copy the output. This becomes **SESSION_SECRET**.

Part 4 — Set up the Hostinger server (one-time)

4.1 — SSH into the server

```
ssh -p 65002 YOUR_USERNAME@YOUR_SERVER_IP
```

4.2 — Clone the repo and build

```
cd ~/domains/your-new-domain.com/public_html
git clone https://github.com/[user]/[new-repo].git .
npm install
npm run build
mkdir -p tmp && touch tmp/restart.txt
```

4.3 — Create the .env.production file

Still inside the server:

```
nano .env.production
```

Paste the following (fill in your real values), then save with Ctrl+X → Y → Enter:

```
OPENAI_API_KEY=sk-proj-xxxxx
ADMIN_PASSWORD_HASH=$2b$12$xxxxx
SESSION_SECRET=xxxxx64charsxxxxx
GITHUB_TOKEN=ghp_xxxxx
GITHUB_REPO=username/new-repo-name
UNSPLASH_ACCESS_KEY=xxxxx # optional
```

Important: Once .env.production is saved, restart the Node app:

```
touch tmp/restart.txt
```

Part 5 — Environment variable reference

All vars go in .env.production on the Hostinger server (NOT in GitHub secrets, except SSH_PASSWORD).

Variable	Required?	Purpose
OPENAI_API_KEY	YES	Powers the AI chat editor
ADMIN_PASSWORD_HASH	YES	Bcrypt hash of admin login password
SESSION_SECRET	YES	Signs session cookies (64-char random)
GITHUB_TOKEN	YES	Lets app save content back to GitHub
GITHUB_REPO	YES	Format: username/repo-name
UNSPLASH_ACCESS_KEY	No	Real photos. Falls back to placeholders.

GitHub repo secrets (only one)

Secret name	Value
SSH_PASSWORD	Your Hostinger SSH password

Part 6 — Reset content and go live

6.1 — Trigger a deploy

Make any commit to **main** in the new repo to fire the GitHub Actions workflow. To trigger manually with an empty commit:

```
git commit --allow-empty -m "trigger deploy" && git push
```

6.2 — Reset content for the new business

Two options:

Option A (easiest): Visit <https://your-new-domain.com/admin>, log in with the new password, and tell the AI: *"Reset everything for a [barbershop/restaurant/etc], the business name is [X]"*

Option B: Edit `content/current.json` in the repo directly before deploying. Change `siteTitle` and clear the `sections` array.

6.3 — Verify it works

- Visit **your-new-domain.com** — should load
- Visit **your-new-domain.com/admin** — should show login
- Log in with the password you set
- Make a test change — should save and persist

Master Checklist (in order)

#	Task	Where
1	Get OpenAI API key + add billing	platform.openai.com
2	Generate GitHub Personal Access Token (repo scope)	github.com/settings/tokens
3	Get Unsplash Access Key (optional)	unsplash.com/developers
4	Buy Hostinger plan + domain, note SSH details	hostinger.com
5	Import builder repo as new private repo	github.com/new/import
6	Update <code>deploy.yml</code> (IP, port, username, domain path)	New repo
7	Add <code>SSH_PASSWORD</code> secret to new repo	GitHub repo settings
8	Generate <code>ADMIN_PASSWORD_HASH</code> with <code>bcryptjs</code>	Your Mac
9	Generate <code>SESSION_SECRET</code> (32 random bytes)	Your Mac
10	SSH into Hostinger server	Terminal
11	Clone repo, <code>npm install</code> , <code>npm run build</code>	Server
12	Create <code>.env.production</code> with all 5–6 vars	Server
13	<code>touch tmp/restart.txt</code> to restart Node	Server
14	Push to <code>main</code> to trigger deploy workflow	GitHub

15	Visit /admin, log in, reset content via AI	Browser
16	Test public site loads correctly	Browser

Tip: Once you've done this once, each new client takes about 30–45 minutes.